



**Dubai delight:** Ravindra Jadeja celebrates with his family after sealing India's victory against New Zealand in the ICC Champions Trophy 2025 final. Jadeja hit the winning runs as India clinched the title with a four-wicket win in Dubai. PTI

unbeaten in three of the four chases, getting the job done (he didn't bat on one occasion). Even with Rishabh Pant waiting on the sidelines, Rahul has shown that he remains India's first-choice wicketkeeper in ODIs.

While every individual contributed, much credit must go to Rohit Sharma, who led the side admirably.

Since he took over as captain, India has refashioned its approach to the limited-overs format, shunning conservatism and embracing a hard-nosed approach that blends flamboyance with pragmatism.

The skipper has been at the forefront of that revolution. His aggressive approach in the PowerPlay, taking more risks in pursuit of quick runs without putting a price on his wicket for the larger

cause, was the hallmark of India's campaigns in the 2023 ODI World Cup and the 2024 T20 World Cup, and he continued in the same vein here.

On sluggish pitches, it was imperative to maximise the PowerPlay (with only two fielders allowed outside the 30-yard circle), and Rohit's methods paid huge dividends.

He had not scored a half-century in the first four matches, but it seemed he had saved his best for the big occasion. His breezy match-winning 76 in the final laid the foundation for India's successful chase of 252.

Over the last few years, Rohit's men have been the atypical scholars in the school of white-ball cricket. They have rigorously studied every fundamental concept required for

success and systematically worked on it, leaving no stone unturned.

The result: India has won 23 out of 24 matches across three ICC white-ball competitions in as many years, clinching two crowns — the ICC T20 World Cup and the ICC Champions Trophy 2025. With this achievement, the current team can rightfully stake a claim to be considered among the best white-ball teams in the history of the sport.

"India is a bloody good team," said Rohit after clinching the title. "Without a doubt, in the last three or four years, we have managed to play the finals of all ICC tournaments, so I'm proud to be the captain of this team. Even though we didn't win the World Cup in 2023, reaching the finals of all four trophies shows how consistent we are as a team."